FLE TRIBE

WEEK 00 · MONDAY · LESSON GUIDE

What is "tech"?

This week: Understand the industry you are entering, the roles inside it, and exactly where a frontend developer fits, so the next 5 months make sense.

Tech is two things

When people say "tech" they usually mean one of two things: the technology industry (companies whose main product is software, like Paystack, Flutterwave, Google or Spotify) or technology as a skill used inside every other industry. Banks, hospitals, airlines, schools and governments all run on software, and they all hire people to build and maintain it.

That is why a frontend developer can work almost anywhere: a fintech startup in Lagos, a bank in London, an agency that builds websites for many clients, or as a freelancer.

The main areas of tech

- **Software engineering**: building apps and websites (frontend, backend, mobile).
- **Data**: collecting, analysing and visualising information to help decisions.
- **Cloud & infrastructure**: the servers and networks software runs on.
- **Cybersecurity**: keeping systems and data safe from attacks.
- **Design (UI/UX)**: researching users and designing how products look and work.
- **Product & project management**: deciding what to build and keeping teams on track.
- **QA / testing**: making sure software works before users see it.

How companies make money from software

- **Subscriptions**: users pay monthly (Netflix, Spotify).
- **Transaction fees**: a small cut of every payment (Paystack, Flutterwave).
- **Advertising**: free for users, paid for by advertisers (Instagram, YouTube).
- **Services**: agencies and freelancers are paid to build software for clients.

Product company or agency?

A **product company** builds and improves its own product for years, so you go deep on one codebase. An **agency** builds projects for many clients, so you see more variety and work to

deadlines. Both are good first jobs; they suit different personalities.

Research questions

Answer these in the app, in your own words, to unlock the next lesson.

1. Name 5 apps you used today. Which company built each, and how does it make money?
2. What is the difference between a product company and an agency?

Start your research here

- roadmap.sh: https://roadmap.sh